Travel & Expenses Policy

1. 1. Purpose and Scope

This policy outlines the procedures and rules for claiming travel and related business expenses at Larkspur Freight. It applies to all full-time and part-time employees traveling for company business, including drivers, sales staff, and management. Contractors and temporary staff are not eligible for reimbursement unless specified in their contract. The policy covers domestic and international travel originating from our main offices in Houston, Tacoma, and Charlotte. Note: Each office may have additional local guidelines—see Section 7.

2. 2. Reimbursable Expenses

Eligible expenses include:
• Airfare (economy class only, booked via TripNest)
• Hotel accommodation up to $180/night (Houston & Charlotte) or $210/night (Tacoma)
• Meals: $55/day per diem (no receipts needed for per diem claims)
• Ground transportation (taxi, rideshare, or rental car from FleetEase)
• Parking and tolls
• Internet charges for business use (max $15/day)
Non-reimbursable: alcohol, personal entertainment, family travel, and upgrades. All expenses must be reasonable and directly related to company business.

3. 3. Approval Workflow

All travel must be pre-approved by the employee’s direct supervisor using the LarkTrack portal. For trips exceeding $2,000 or international travel, approval from the Finance Manager (currently: Dana Kim) is also required. Expense reports must be submitted within 7 days of trip completion. Late submissions may result in delayed or denied reimbursement. Supervisors have 3 business days to review and approve or reject claims.

4. 4. Documentation Requirements

Employees must submit itemized receipts for all expenses over $25, except for per diem meals. Receipts must be uploaded to the LarkTrack portal in PDF or JPEG format. Credit card statements are not accepted as proof. For hotel stays, the folio showing nightly rates and taxes is required. Missing documentation may result in partial reimbursement or rejection of the claim. Expense reports must include a brief business purpose for each trip.

5. 5. Advances and Corporate Cards

Travel advances are available for trips longer than 5 days and must be requested at least 10 business days in advance. Advances are capped at 80% of estimated expenses. Employees issued a Larkspur Corporate Card (via Bank of Westfield) must reconcile charges within 5 days of statement receipt. Personal expenses charged to the corporate card must be repaid within 14 days. Misuse of the card may result in revocation and disciplinary action.

6. 6. Exceptions and Special Cases

Requests for exceptions (e.g., higher hotel rates during conferences, additional baggage fees) must be submitted in writing to the Finance Manager before travel. Emergency expenses (e.g., medical, weather-related delays) will be reviewed on a case-by-case basis. Tacoma office employees may claim up to $25/day for winter gear rental (November–March) with supervisor approval. All exceptions must be documented in the expense report.

7. 7. Office-Specific Guidelines

Houston: Employees must use MetroCab for airport transfers (company account #HST-4421). Charlotte: Parking at CLT airport is reimbursed up to $12/day. Tacoma: Employees traveling to Alaska routes may claim an additional $40/day hardship allowance. Local finance contacts: Houston – Mark Feldman, Charlotte – Priya Desai, Tacoma – Luis Ortega. Refer to the LarkTrack portal for updates to local rules.